

PAKISTAN

1. Turkish Energy Minister's visit set to boost bilateral cooperation: Minister for Petroleum (Ali Pervaiz Malik) on Dec 01 said Islamabad looks forward to welcoming the high-level Turkish delegation arriving on Dec 02, led by Turkish Minister of Energy and Natural Resources (Alparslan Bayraktar). Minister Malik said their visit will play a transformational role in advancing our bilateral cooperation in energy and mining sector. (Associated Press of Pakistan)

2. Egyptian FM calls on Field Marshal Asim Munir: Foreign Minister of Egypt (Badr Ahmed Mohamed Abdelatty) met with Field Marshal (Asim Munir) Chief of Army Staff on Dec 01. During the meeting, both dignitaries reviewed bilateral relations, with a particular focus on defence and security cooperation, military-to-military contacts, training collaborations, and regional peace and stability. (The Express Tribune)

3. Pakistan invites Egyptian Elsewedy Electric to explore mining, IT investments: Minister for Commerce (Jam Kamal Khan) held a productive meeting on Dec 01 with (Eng. Ahmed Elsewedy) President and CEO of Elsewedy Electric. During the meeting, the minister highlights Pakistan's mining sector, investor-friendly frameworks and emerging public-private partnership opportunities. (Business Recorder)

CHINA

4. French President to pay State visit to China: At the invitation of Chinese President (Xi Jinping), French President (Emmanuel Macron) will pay a state visit to China from December 3 to 5. During the upcoming visit, President Xi will hold talks with President Macron to jointly guide the development of the bilateral relationship under new circumstances and have in-depth exchange of views on major international and regional hotspot issues. (Global Times)

5. Vietnamese frigate visits eastern Chinese city of Qingdao: Vietnamese frigate Tran Hung Dao arrived at a naval port in the city of Qingdao in east China's Shandong Province on Dec 1. During the visit, the Chinese and Vietnamese navies will hold ship tours, deck receptions, cultural exchanges and joint drills, among other activities. This visit aims to enhance mutual understanding between the two navies, and to deepen the friendship between the two countries. (Xinhua)

6. Egypt-China launch joint production of new armed drone: As reported on Dec 1, China and Egypt have agreed to cooperate on the local production of armed UAVs, signalling a new stage in bilateral defense ties. The deal was formalized through a memorandum of understanding signed on Dec 1, between Egypt's Arab Organization for Industrialization and China's NORINCO. (Defence Blog)

MYANMAR

7. Fighting reported on Mogok-Momeik road between KIA and Military: The Kachin Independence Army on Dec 01, has mentioned that fighting broke out with regime

forces at an unspecified location along the Mogok-Momeik Road, somewhere between Mogok Township in Mandalay Region and Momeik Township in northern Shan State, on Nov 30. (Voice of Burma)

8. Junta sets up Committee to expedite China-backed Muse-Mandalay Railway: It is reported on Dec 01, that Myanmar's junta has formed a national-level Project Steering Committee to push ahead with construction of the Muse-Mandalay railway, a key segment of both China's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) and the China-Myanmar Economic Corridor. (Irrawaddy)

BANGLADESH

9. 'Eight-party alliance' fighting for people's victory Jamaat Ameer: It is reported on Dec 01, that Jamaat Ameer (Shafiqur Rahman) on Dec 01 said that the eight-party alliance does not want victory only for itself, but for the 180 million people of Bangladesh. The Ameer mentioned that they want to keep fighting for a corruption free society, justice, economic freedom and an independent country free from any kind of control. (Dhaka Tribune)

NEPAL

10. Congress central committee decides to organise party general convention: The Nepali Congress on Dec 01, ended a prolonged internal dispute by unanimously endorsing a proposal to hold the party's general convention from January 10 to 12. Party spokesperson (Prakash Sharan Mahat) said that the central working committee meeting held at Sanepa-based party office approved the general convention date proposed by acting party president Purna Bahadur Khadka. (Kathmandu Post)

BHUTAN

11. Denchukha road reopens after two- month closure: It is reported on Dec 01, that road connectivity has been temporarily restored in Denchukha after the Gewog remained cut-off for nearly two months due to monsoon damage. As per the post restoration work is now underway, with about five excavators deployed across the Gewog for road clearance. (Kuensel Online)

SRI LANKA

12. Sri Lanka Air Force helicopter crash in Lunuwila: On December 01, it is reported that a Sri Lanka Air Force Bell 212 helicopter engaged in humanitarian relief operations crash-landed into Gin Oya in Lunuwila killing its pilot and injuring four crew members. The helicopter was delivering food and supplies to residents affected by ongoing floods and landslides when it went down. (The morning)

13. China announces emergency assistance for disaster relief efforts in Sri Lanka: On December 01, it is reported that the Chinese embassy in Colombo has issued a statement that to support the disaster relief efforts by Sri Lankans, the Red Cross Society of China has disbursed USD 100,000 in emergency cash aid to the Sri

Lanka. (Adaderana)

MALDIVES

14. Vast-MSRO sign MoU to engage Maldives Space Industry: On Dec 01, Vast has signed an MoU with the Maldives Space Research Organization to explore opportunities that engage the Republic of Maldives' space industry. Vast and the MSRO will there by collaborate on human spaceflight opportunities, science, research, and education. Through the partnership, the organizations will subsequently pursue astronaut flight such as Haven-1. (Space watch global)

15. Atoll Councils to be dissolved following constitutional amendment: President (Mohamed Muizzu) ratified the seventh amendment to the constitution of the Maldives on Dec 01, abolishing the establishment of atoll councils in the country. The amendment is now in effect following its publication in the Government gazette. (Corporate Maldives)

CENTRAL & WEST ASIA

16. Hamas says international force in Gaza must be limited to ceasefire monitoring: As reported on Dec 01, Hamas political bureau member (Husam Badran) said any international force deployed in the Gaza Strip should be limited to monitoring the ceasefire and ensuring civilian protection, as Palestinian factions presented a unified position on the issue during recent talks in Cairo. (Turkey Today)

17. Turkish defense firm Aselsan launches LUNA-1 low-Earth-orbit satellite: Turkish defense firm Aselsan announced on Dec 01, that it launched the LUNA-1 low orbit IoT satellite with a SpaceX Falcon-9 rocket. (Anadolu Agency)

27. Turkish defense minister meets Somalia's marine transport minister: On Dec 01, it is reported that Turkish Defense Minister (Yasar Guler) met with Somalia's Minister of Ports and Marine Transport (Abdulkadir Mohamed Nur). The Defense Ministry said the meeting took place at its Ankara headquarters. (Mehr News)

28. Iran-Japan FMs discuss regional & international issues: Iranian Foreign Minister (Abbas Araghchi) and his Japanese counterpart (Toshimitsu Motegi) held a telephonic conversation on Dec 01, to discuss bilateral ties and issues of the mutual interest. (Tehran Times)